

HIGHER SECONDARY SECOND YEAR (H.S. 2nd Year)
POLITICAL SCIENCE – 2020 (Code: 30T POSC)

Solved Question Paper (Guide)

Full Marks: 100 | Time: 3 Hours

Note: As this is a guide, all questions are solved, including every 'OR' / 'Any ____' question.

PART – A : Contemporary World Politics

Q.1 (1 mark each)

Q.1(a) Write the full form of NATO.

Ans:

North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (formed 1949).

Q.1(b) _____ initiated the reforms in Soviet Union in 1985.

Ans:

Mikhail Gorbachev.

Q.1(c) In which year Iraq invaded Kuwait?

Ans:

1990 (2 August 1990).

Q.1(d) Which event does '9/11' refer to in the context of contemporary world politics?

Ans:

The terrorist attack on the World Trade Center in New York and the Pentagon in Washington, USA, on 11 September 2001.

Q.1(e) What do you mean by 'Operation Desert Storm'?

Ans:

It was the code name of the US-led military operation (1991) of the coalition forces against Iraq to free Kuwait after Iraq's invasion; it is also called the First Gulf War.

Q.1(f) Where was the First SAARC Summit held?

Ans:

Dhaka (Bangladesh), in December 1985.

Q.2 – 7 (2 marks each)

Q.2 Write two principles of New International Economic Order.

Ans:

- Developing countries should have full control over their natural resources.
- Fairer trade: access to Western markets, better prices for raw materials and transfer of cheaper technology.

Q.3 Why did big powers need to have alliance with smaller countries? Write two reasons.

Ans:

- To get resources such as oil and minerals and to secure markets for their goods.
- To get strategic locations and military bases and the political support of small states in the UN and other bodies.

Q.4 Write two causes of disintegration of Soviet Union.

Ans:

- Economic stagnation and inefficiency of the centralised planned economy, along with heavy military spending.
- Rise of nationalism in the republics and Gorbachev's reforms (Glasnost and Perestroika), which weakened the Communist Party's control.

Q.5 Write two constraints on American hegemony.

Ans:

- Institutional architecture of the American political system (separation of powers and checks and balances) limits the unchecked use of military power.
- Open nature of American society (public opinion, e.g., in the Vietnam war) and the role of alliances like NATO and rising powers like China restrain US dominance.

Q.6 In which year was the World Bank created? Mention any one activity of the World Bank.

Ans:

The World Bank was created in 1944 (Bretton Woods Conference; started working in 1945–46). One activity: it gives loans and technical help to member countries for reconstruction and development projects (roads, power, education, health).

Q.7 What is the difference between traditional and non-traditional security?

Ans:

- Traditional security is concerned with military threats to a state's territory and sovereignty from other states (war, invasion); it relies on military power and alliances.
- Non-traditional security covers wider threats to human beings such as poverty, hunger, epidemics, terrorism, migration and environmental degradation, and needs cooperation rather than military force.

Q.8 – 12 (4 marks each)

Q.8 Discuss briefly the causes of conflict between India and Pakistan.

Ans:

The main causes of conflict between India and Pakistan are:

- Kashmir: both claim the territory; wars in 1947–48, 1965 and 1999 (Kargil) were fought over it.
- Partition legacy: communal violence, migration and distrust; and the 1971 war which led to the creation of Bangladesh.
- Cross-border terrorism, which India accuses Pakistan of supporting.
- Water sharing, Siachen glacier and Sir Creek disputes, and nuclear rivalry and arms race.

Q.9 Discuss briefly about the need of reforms in the United Nations.

Ans:

Reforms in the UN are needed because:

- The Security Council reflects the post-1945 world: it has no permanent seat for Asia, Africa or Latin America (India, Brazil, Germany, Japan, South Africa want seats).
- The veto power of the P5 is undemocratic and is misused for national interest.
- The UN needs more funds and the power to act quickly in peacekeeping and humanitarian crises, and the General Assembly needs to be stronger.
- New problems like terrorism, climate change and epidemics need a more effective UN.

Q.10 What is the relationship between human security and health? Discuss briefly.

Ans:

Human security means protection of people from threats like hunger, disease, violence and poverty. Health is a basic part of it:

- Epidemics and pandemics such as HIV/AIDS, SARS, bird flu, Ebola and COVID-19 kill many people and spread across borders because of travel and trade.
- Poor health reduces people's ability to work, causing poverty, and it harms the economy and social stability.
- Health problems are linked to poverty, malnutrition, poor sanitation and conflict, so states must cooperate through the WHO to guarantee health security.

Q.11 What is the relationship between the rights of indigenous people and environment? Discuss briefly.

Ans:

Indigenous peoples (adivasis, tribals) have lived in close relationship with nature for centuries. The relationship between their rights and the environment is:

- Their livelihood, culture and religion depend on forests, land, rivers and sacred groves; they conserve nature through traditional knowledge.
- Development projects like dams, mining and deforestation displace them, damaging both their rights and the environment.
- Protecting the environment protects indigenous rights; the UN has recognised their rights and the World Council of Indigenous Peoples (1975) works for this.
- Thus, their rights to land and resources are essential for environmental protection.

Q.12 Write two arguments in favour of and two arguments against globalization.

Ans:

Arguments in favour:

- It increases trade, investment, employment and economic growth, and gives consumers more choice.
- It spreads technology, information and cultural exchange.

Arguments against:

- It widens inequality between and within countries, and local industries and farmers suffer.
- It weakens state sovereignty, harms the environment and threatens local cultures.

Q.13 – 14 (6 marks each)

Q.13 Discuss the consequences of disintegration of Soviet Union.

Ans:

Consequences of the disintegration of the Soviet Union:

- End of the Cold War and the bipolar world; the USA became the sole superpower (unipolar world), and the ideological contest ended.
- Fifteen new independent countries emerged (Russia, Ukraine, Kazakhstan, etc.); Russia became the successor state and took the UN seat.
- Shock therapy led to the collapse of the economy; many former socialist states adopted capitalism; the arms race ended and the Warsaw Pact dissolved.
- Many conflicts occurred in these states (Chechnya, Georgia, Tajikistan); NATO and the EU expanded in Eastern Europe.

- Weakening of the Non-Aligned Movement; India had to adjust its foreign policy and economy (1991 reforms).

[OR] Q.13 Discuss the latest trend in Indo-U.S. relationship.

Ans:

Indo-US relations have improved much since the end of the Cold War:

- Earlier relations were cool as India followed non-alignment and the USA supported Pakistan; the 1998 nuclear tests also created tension.
- Since 2000 (Clinton's visit) relations have improved; the Civil Nuclear Deal (2005/2008) was an important step.
- Strategic partnership: defence cooperation (logistics agreements, Malabar exercises), Quad (US, India, Japan, Australia) and Indo-Pacific cooperation.
- Strong trade and technology ties, large Indian-American community; cooperation against terrorism.
- Issues: trade and tariffs, Russia oil/arms purchase, and visa issues, but ties continue to grow.

Q.14 Examine the political and diplomatic influence of European Union.

Ans:

The EU has strong political and diplomatic influence:

- Political: it has its own institutions (Parliament, Commission, Council) and pools sovereignty; acts as a model for regional integration; admits new members after the criteria of democracy and human rights are met.
- Diplomatic: two of its members (France and UK till Brexit) are permanent members of the UNSC; the EU speaks in the G-8/G-20, WTO and negotiates trade and climate agreements.
- It uses 'soft power' (aid, trade, sanctions) and has influenced peace in Europe, as seen with the neighbours (Eastern Europe) and in the Balkans.
- It has a European External Action Service and a common foreign and security policy, though its members sometimes disagree (e.g., on Iraq 2003).

[OR] Q.14 Describe the aims and achievements of ASEAN.

Ans:

ASEAN was formed in 1967 (Bangkok Declaration).

Aims:

- To accelerate economic growth, social progress and cultural development in the region.
- To promote regional peace and stability, and to cooperate in trade, science and technology.

Achievements:

- It has kept Southeast Asia largely peaceful; created the ASEAN Regional Forum, the ASEAN Free Trade Area and the ASEAN Economic Community.
- It has increased its membership to ten and cooperates with India, China, Japan and others (ASEAN+). Its success lies in the 'ASEAN Way' of consultation, non-interference and consensus.

PART – B : Politics in India Since Independence

Q.15 (1 mark each)

Q.15(a) India has a multi-party system. (True/False)

Ans:

True.

Q.15(b) Chairman of the drafting committee of the Constituent Assembly?

Ans:

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar.

Q.15(c) Simla Agreement was signed between India and _____.

Ans:

Pakistan (1972).

Q.15(d) Where was the first Non-Aligned Summit held?

Ans:

Belgrade (Yugoslavia), 1961.

Q.15(e) Article _____ of the Indian Constitution gave special status to Jammu and Kashmir.

Ans:

Article 370.

Q.15(f) Write the full form of 'NEDA'.

Ans:

North East Democratic Alliance (formed 2016).

Q.16 – 21 (2 marks each)

Q.16 Mention any two ideologies of Bharatiya Jana Sangh.

Ans:

The Bharatiya Jana Sangh's two ideologies:

- 'One country, one culture, one nation': Hindu cultural nationalism and Akhand Bharat.
- Opposition to special status of Jammu and Kashmir, support for a Uniform Civil Code and ban on cow slaughter.

Q.17 When was the Election Commission of India formed? Who was the first Election Commissioner?

Ans:

The Election Commission of India was formed on 25 January 1950. The first Chief Election Commissioner was Sukumar Sen.

Q.18 Write two consequences of Emergency of 1975.

Ans:

- Fundamental rights were suspended and the press was censored; thousands of opposition leaders were arrested.
- The Congress was defeated in the 1977 election and the Janata Party formed the first non-Congress government.

Q.19 Write any two factors responsible for the emergence of regional political parties in India.

Ans:

- Growth of regional identity (language, culture) and neglect of regions by the Centre.
- Decline of the Congress and the coalition era after 1989, which gave regional parties a bargaining role.

Q.20 Write two recommendations of the Mandal Commission.

Ans:

- 27 per cent reservation of jobs in central government for the Other Backward Classes (OBCs).

- Similar reservation in educational institutions and land reforms and other steps to improve the economic condition of OBCs.

Q.21 Mention two main features of New Economic Policy in India.

Ans:

- Liberalisation: removal of licences and controls on industry and trade.
- Privatisation and globalisation: reduced role of the government in industries, opening the economy to foreign investment and MNCs.

Q.22 – 26 (4 marks each)

Q.22 Explain briefly the consequences of Partition of India.

Ans:

The Partition of 1947 led to:

- Communal violence in which lakhs of people were killed, especially in Punjab and Bengal.
- Mass migration of about 80 lakh people, creating a refugee and rehabilitation problem.
- Division of resources, army and administration; economic loss (jute, tea, railways).
- Kashmir problem and lasting hostility between India and Pakistan; communal tension in India; Sylhet's separation from Assam (affecting Karimganj area).

Q.23 Discuss briefly about India's Nuclear Policy.

Ans:

India's nuclear policy:

- India conducted its first nuclear test at Pokhran in 1974 (peaceful nuclear explosion) and further tests in May 1998 (Pokhran-II) and became a nuclear weapon state.
- India follows the policy of 'No First Use' and 'credible minimum deterrence'; nuclear weapons are for defence only.
- India did not sign the NPT and CTBT calling them discriminatory, but supports global nuclear disarmament.
- The Indo-US Civil Nuclear Deal (2008) and the NSG waiver helped India to access nuclear fuel and technology for peaceful use.

Q.24 Discuss briefly about the controversy relating to Presidential Election of 1969.

Ans:

The 1969 Presidential election was a conflict between Indira Gandhi and the Congress 'Syndicate' (old guard):

- After the death of President Zakir Husain, the Syndicate nominated Neelam Sanjiva Reddy as the official Congress candidate.
- Indira Gandhi supported V.V. Giri (Vice President) as an independent and asked MPs to vote according to their 'conscience'; she also nationalised 14 banks and removed Morarji Desai as finance minister.
- V.V. Giri won by a narrow margin; this led to the Congress split in 1969 (Congress (O) and Congress (R)) and Indira Gandhi emerged stronger.

Q.25 Discuss briefly about Chipko Movement.

Ans:

Chipko Movement was a non-violent environmental movement started in 1973 in the Garhwal Himalayas (Uttarakhand, then Uttar Pradesh), when the villagers (especially women) hugged ('chipko' means to stick) trees to stop contractors from cutting them.

- Leaders: Sunderlal Bahuguna, Chandi Prasad Bhatt and Gaura Devi.
- It demanded the people's rights over local forests and led the government to ban felling of trees in the Himalayan region for 15 years; it became a symbol of ecological movements and women's participation.

Q.26 Discuss briefly the main features of Coalition Govt. in India.

Ans:

Features of coalition government in India:

- Two or more parties join together to form the government, since no single party has an absolute majority in the Lok Sabha.
- A Common Minimum Programme or an agreed agenda is made (e.g., UPA 2004).
- Regional parties play an important role and enjoy a bargaining power; ministerial posts are shared.
- Decisions are slower and the government can be unstable (e.g., 1990s), as parties may withdraw support; the Prime Minister has less power than in a majority government.

Q.27 – 28 (6 marks each)

Q.27 Discuss the economic and political results of Green Revolution.

Ans:

The Green Revolution was the introduction of high-yielding variety (HYV) seeds, chemical fertilisers, pesticides and irrigation in the 1960s, led by M.S. Swaminathan and Norman Borlaug, mainly in Punjab, Haryana and western Uttar Pradesh (wheat and rice).

Economic results:

- Food grain production increased greatly and India became self-sufficient; farmers' incomes rose and the rural economy grew.
- However, regional inequality (only some states) and inequality between rich and poor farmers increased; the environment was harmed (soil and groundwater damage).

Political results:

- The rich/middle peasantry became politically powerful (farmers' movements like BKU), and Congress strengthened its rural base.
- Poor peasants and landless labourers got less benefit, which led to rural conflicts and radical Leftist movements (Naxalite).

[OR] Q.27 State the main arguments in the debate between Industrialisation and Agriculture Development at the time of Second Five Year Plan.

Ans:

The debate between industrialisation and agriculture at the time of the Second Five Year Plan (1956):

- The Second Plan, prepared on the Mahalanobis model, stressed heavy industry (steel, power, machine-building) and public sector for rapid growth, self-reliance and employment.
- Supporters (Nehru, Mahalanobis) argued that industry alone could remove poverty in the long term, and reduce dependence on imports.
- Critics (J.C. Kumarappa, Gandhians, and economists like Chaudhuri Charan Singh and the Swatantra Party) argued that agriculture and small/village industries should come first as most people lived in villages, and that heavy industry was capital-intensive, offered few jobs and caused food shortages.
- The result: industrial growth increased but agriculture was neglected, leading to food crises in the 1960s and later the Green Revolution.

Q.28 Analyse the lessons India got from emergency.

Ans:

Lessons India learned from the Emergency:

- Democracy is deeply rooted: the people punished the government in the 1977 election, showing that Indians value democracy.
- The Constitution's emergency provisions were misused, so the 44th Amendment (1978) limited them: 'internal disturbance' was replaced by 'armed rebellion', and the President needs written advice of the Cabinet.
- The importance of civil liberties, freedom of press and an independent judiciary was realised; courts and civil society began to protect rights (PIL and the right to life under Article 21).
- The danger of centralisation of power and personality cult; the need for opposition and inner-party democracy.

[OR] Q.28 Describe about the politics of the North-East and the demands of autonomy in the region.

Ans:

North-East India consists of seven sister states (plus Sikkim) with great ethnic, linguistic and cultural diversity and a weak economy. Its politics and demands for autonomy include:

- Demand for autonomy: the Sixth Schedule provides Autonomous District Councils for tribals (e.g., Karbi Anglong, Bodoland Territorial Council); there are demands for Bodoland, Gorkhaland-like and Kamtapur statehood.
- The Assam Movement (1979–85) against foreigners (the Assam Accord, 1985), and insurgency by ULFA, NSCN and others.
- States were reorganised: Nagaland (1963), Meghalaya (1972), Manipur and Tripura (1972), Mizoram and Arunachal (1987).
- The causes: sense of neglect, migration, loss of land and identity, and underdevelopment.

The Centre responded with accords (Mizo Accord 1986, Bodo Accord 2003 and 2020), development packages and the Look/Act East policy.